

# Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

## Chapter 4: New Beginnings: Cities and States

### Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

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|------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Subject</b>         | Social Science (NCERT Class 7)        |
| <b>Chapter</b>         | 4 — New Beginnings: Cities and States |
| <b>Total Questions</b> | 60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)  |
| <b>Maximum Marks</b>   | 240                                   |
| <b>Suggested Time</b>  | 90 minutes                            |

**Marking scheme:** +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

**Instructions:** Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Distinguish the First (Harappan) from the Second (Ganga-plains) Urbanisation, remember that some mahaajanapadas (Vajji, Malla) were ganas/sanghas not monarchies, and keep janapada (clan territory) separate from mahaajanapada (the larger states that grew out of them). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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**1.** A student lists four traits of India's First Urbanisation: planned drainage, a writing system, standardised weights, and widespread iron ploughs. One trait does NOT belong. Which one, and why?

- (A) Widespread iron ploughs — iron came into general use only much later, during the Second Urbanisation, not in Harappan times
- (B) Planned drainage — the Harappans had no organised drains in their cities
- (C) A writing system — the Harappans never used any script
- (D) Standardised weights — the Harappans traded only by rough guess, never by fixed measures

**2.** Between the breakdown of the Harappan cities and the rise of cities in the Ganga plains, the Subcontinent went through a long phase. The MOST accurate description of that phase is:

- (A) A phase of continuous, uninterrupted city life that simply moved east
- (B) A short pause of about a hundred years before bigger cities returned
- (C) A largely non-urban, village-based phase lasting roughly a thousand years, with little trade, writing or city administration
- (D) A period when iron cities flourished across the whole Subcontinent

**3.** Why is it MORE accurate to call the Ganga-plains city wave a 'Second' Urbanisation rather than a 'revival' of the Harappan cities?

- (A) It was built by the same people in the very same Indus cities
- (B) It arose independently centuries later in a different region with new features such as iron and coins, not as a continuation of the Harappan cities
- (C) It copied the Harappan script and weights exactly
- (D) It happened only a few years after the Harappan collapse

**4.** A historian writes: 'The collapse of the Harappan cities was a loss of urban ORDER, not merely of buildings.' Which observation BEST supports this stronger claim?

- (A) A few mud-brick walls fell down but daily life carried on exactly as before
- (B) People immediately built much larger cities somewhere nearby
- (C) Trade networks, the writing system and city administration all faded, and people went back to simple village life
- (D) Iron tools spread the moment the Harappan cities ended

**5.** To reconstruct the Second Urbanisation, historians lean on archaeology AND ancient texts. The MAIN advantage of having both kinds of evidence together is that:

- (A) Texts can replace excavation entirely, so digging is unnecessary
- (B) Archaeology alone gives the exact words people spoke
- (C) Where the dug-up remains and the written accounts agree, the historian can be far more confident the picture is reliable
- (D) Together they prove that the Harappans themselves wrote the histories

**6.** Arrange these correctly from EARLIEST to LATEST: (i) the first great empires, (ii) janapadas formed by settled clans, (iii) the Harappan civilisation, (iv) the sixteen mahaajanapadas.

- (A) (iii) → (iv) → (ii) → (i)
- (B) (iii) → (ii) → (iv) → (i)
- (C) (ii) → (iii) → (iv) → (i)
- (D) (iii) → (ii) → (i) → (iv)

**7.** The word janapada combines jana ('people') and pada ('foot'). Reading the word's own logic, a janapada is BEST understood as:

- (A) A marching army that never stayed in one place
- (B) A single coin stamped with a foot symbol
- (C) A territory where a people had settled and put down roots
- (D) A vast empire ruling many distant lands

**8.** Why are janapadas counted among India's earliest STATES, even though they were small and clan-based?

- (A) Settled clans identified with a fixed territory and needed a rajaa to lead, protect and organise it
- (B) They governed themselves with no leader of any kind

- (C) They were the original cities built by the Harappans
- (D) They issued their own iron coins from the start

**9.** Over time many separate janapadas combined into fewer, larger units. The term coined for these larger units, and the most-cited count of them, are:

- (A) ganas, with ten most often listed
- (B) mahaajanapadas, with sixteen most often listed
- (C) sanghas, with twelve most often listed
- (D) janapadas, with twenty most often listed

**10.** Why did the Ganga plains, rather than a desert or a high mountain belt, become crowded with mahaajanapadas?

- (A) The plains were cold and dry, which armies preferred
- (B) The plains had no rivers, so it was easy to march everywhere
- (C) The Harappans had already built their main capitals there
- (D) Fertile soil produced food surpluses, iron was available, and rivers and routes linked the region for trade

**11.** A mahaajanapada capital was typically ringed by ramparts and, just outside, a moat. Reasoning about defence, the moat MAINLY served to:

- (A) Store the city's drinking water for festivals
- (B) Mark the boundary of the king's private garden
- (C) Form a water-filled barrier that slowed or blocked attackers reaching the walls
- (D) Provide an open square for the daily market

**12.** Gateways in a capital's walls were often deliberately kept narrow. The BEST explanation in terms of how a state works is that:

- (A) Narrow gates let rainwater drain away faster
- (B) Narrow gates made the city look more beautiful
- (C) Narrow gates allowed two elephants to pass side by side
- (D) A few guards could then control and inspect everyone and everything passing in or out

**13.** Rajagriha, Kaushambi and Varanasi were capitals about 2,500 years ago and remain busy cities today. The SOUNDEST inference from this continuity is that:

- (A) Nothing about these places has changed in 2,500 years
- (B) They must have been founded by the Harappans
- (C) They were never actually fortified at all
- (D) Their sites offered lasting natural and strategic advantages worth living on for millennia

**14.** In the janapadas and monarchical mahaajanapadas the rajaa was advised by two assemblies, the sabhaa and the samiti, names first found in the Vedas. A student infers from this that:

- (A) The king had no real power and the assemblies ruled alone
- (B) The people elected a brand-new king every single year
- (C) Even a king was expected to take counsel and not simply rule by personal whim
- (D) There were no kings at all in these states

**15.** In a monarchical mahaajanapada the office of rajaa was hereditary. The clearest practical consequence of 'hereditary' kingship was that:

- (A) The assembly voted to choose a new ruler each time
- (B) The wealthiest merchant of the city became the next ruler
- (C) The throne normally passed within the family, typically to the king's son
- (D) A conquering foreigner automatically inherited the throne

**16.** A gana or sangha differed from a monarchy in HOW its ruler came to power. In a gana/sangha the rajaa was:

- (A) Always the eldest son of the previous rajaa
- (B) Chosen by priests inherited from Harappan times
- (C) Imposed by a distant foreign empire
- (D) Selected by the assembly through discussion and, if needed, a vote

**17.** Two of the sixteen mahaajanapadas, Vajji (Vrijji) and Malla, are singled out as 'early republics.' The single feature that EARNs them that label is that:

- (A) They were simply larger in territory than the others
- (B) They possessed stronger armies than the monarchies
- (C) They were the only ones to use punch-marked coins
- (D) Their assemblies took the major decisions and even selected the ruler, instead of power passing by birth

**18.** A classmate insists, 'All sixteen mahaajanapadas were ruled by hereditary kings.' The MOST accurate correction is:

- (A) Most were monarchies, but Vajji and Malla were ganas/sanghas where the assembly held the real decision-making power
- (B) Correct — there were no exceptions at all
- (C) Wrong — none of them ever had a king
- (D) Correct, but only the southern ones had kings

**19.** Why are Vajji and Malla called EARLY republics rather than full modern democracies?

- (A) They had no assemblies whatsoever
- (B) Decisions were taken jointly by the heads of leading families, not by every individual through universal voting
- (C) Their rulers were always chosen by birth
- (D) Only women were allowed to take any decisions

**20.** Compare the FIRST Urbanisation's metal expertise with the technological key to the SECOND. The contrast is BEST stated as:

- (A) The Harappans used iron, while the second wave returned to bronze
- (B) Both waves depended mainly on gold tools
- (C) The Harappans used silver coins, the second wave used iron coins
- (D) The Harappans mastered copper and bronze, while the Second Urbanisation was driven by the spread of iron

**21.** Iron tools mattered far more for state-building than gold or silver ever could. The cause-and-effect reason is that:

- (A) Iron was worshipped, so people gathered into cities to honour it
- (B) Iron removed any further need for trade and routes
- (C) Iron was used to print the first books, spreading knowledge
- (D) Iron axes and ploughs cleared forests and broke heavy soil, raising the food surpluses that fed cities and armies

**22.** Iron also strengthened armies. The chapter connects stronger armies to:

- (A) The growth of bigger kingdoms as states conquered and absorbed their neighbours
- (B) The complete disappearance of warfare
- (C) The end of farming across the plains
- (D) The first invention of writing

**23.** A coin specialist explains that India's first coins were made of silver with symbols hammered in. The proper name and the reason for it are:

- (A) Cowrie coins, because shells were strung together
- (B) Punch-marked coins, because symbols were punched (stamped) into the soft silver
- (C) Cast coins, because gold was poured into moulds
- (D) Boxing coins, because they were used as fighting prizes

**24.** The chapter says coins were introduced MAINLY to solve a problem with barter. That problem is BEST described as:

- (A) Barter could only be carried out after sunset
- (B) Barter required a bank in every town
- (C) In barter you must find someone who has what you want and also wants what you have
- (D) Barter needed iron tools to complete a trade

**25.** Finding one mahaajanapada's punch-marked coins far away in another region BEST supports which conclusion?

- (A) Coins moved along the trade routes, so regions used and exchanged one another's coins
- (B) The coins must be modern forgeries planted yesterday
- (C) Every region across India used exactly one identical coin
- (D) Coins could only ever be spent inside the city that made them

**26.** Indian society of this age organised itself partly through varna and jaati. A jaati is BEST described as:

- (A) A water-filled ditch dug for the defence of a city
- (B) An occupational community whose skills and customs were passed from parents to children
- (C) A long-distance route used for trade and pilgrimage
- (D) A silver coin stamped with several symbols

**27.** Within the four-fold varna scheme, which pairing of varna and expected role is CORRECT?

- (A) Kshatriyas — defending society and the land, and waging war when necessary
- (B) Brahmins — defending the land in battle
- (C) Vaishyas — performing rituals and preserving knowledge
- (D) Shudras — ruling the kingdom as warriors

**28.** A student claims, 'The varna-jaati system was rigid and unchanging from the very first day.' The chapter corrects this by noting that:

- (A) It never actually existed in this period
- (B) It applied only to the Harappan cities
- (C) In the early period it was more flexible, and people could change occupations as circumstances required
- (D) It became completely rigid on the very day it began

**29.** Two great highways tied India's regions together. Matching each correctly:

- (A) The Uttaraapatha ran south; the Dakshinaapatha ran north
- (B) Both routes ran only east to west along the coast
- (C) Both routes lay entirely inside a single mahaajanapada
- (D) The Uttaraapatha was the northern route; the Dakshinaapatha ran toward the south

**30.** The Dakshinaapatha began near today's Prayagraj (at Kaushambi) and then crossed a particular range to reach the south. That range was the:

- (A) Himalayas
- (B) Aravalli Range
- (C) Western Ghats
- (D) Vindhya Range

**31.** Beyond goods, the great trade routes also carried something that helped knit the Subcontinent together culturally. That 'something' included:

- (A) Only the rajaa's private letters
- (B) Only soldiers and nothing else
- (C) Pilgrims, armies, ideas and coins moving between regions
- (D) Only iron ore and no people

**32.** Around 400 BCE three kingdoms rose in the SOUTHERN part of the Subcontinent. They were the:

(A) Magadha, Kosala and Avanti

(B) Vajji, Malla and Anga

(C) Kuru, Panchaala and Matsya

(D) Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas

**33.** Why did the south become drawn into trade with the rest of the Subcontinent?

(A) It had an unusually cold climate that attracted traders

(B) It had no rivers at all, which made travel simple

(C) It held valuable resources such as gems, gold and spices that other regions wanted

(D) It lay far from the sea and so needed inland goods

**34.** By about 300-200 BCE the chapter describes the Subcontinent as having become:

(A) Completely emptied of people once again

(B) One vibrant, interconnected land whose goods and culture even reached beyond India

(C) Split into three separate islands

(D) Ruled once more entirely by the Harappans

**35.** Around the same time that India became one interconnected land, what happened to the mahaajanapadas?

(A) They were only just being founded for the very first time

(B) They came to an end, clearing the way for the first great empires

(C) They all converted into ganas/sanghas

(D) They relocated westward into the Indus valley

**36.** Which chain of cause and effect from the chapter is correctly ordered?

(A) Iron spread → more farmland was cleared → food surpluses grew → cities and states grew

(B) Coins were invented → barter began → trade stopped

(C) Cities grew → forests reappeared → iron vanished

(D) Empires formed → janapadas appeared → clans settled

**37.** Magadha in present-day Bihar became one of the most powerful mahaajanapadas. Following the chapter's logic, the SINGLE best reason is that it:

(A) Had no rivers, making it naturally easy to defend

(B) Sat on the fertile middle Ganga plain with food surpluses, river transport and nearby resources

(C) Was a gana/sangha that elected its rulers (D) Lay far to the south near the Pandyas

**38.** Someone claims, 'The Second Urbanisation has never really stopped — it continues to this day.' Which fact BEST backs this up?

(A) All the Harappan cities are still inhabited today

(B) Iron tools have completely fallen out of use

(C) Barter is still India's main form of trade

(D) Several mahaajanapada capitals, such as Varanasi, are still living cities about 2,500 years later

**39.** State the KEY governance difference between a monarchy like Magadha and a gana/sangha like Vajji.

(A) In Magadha one hereditary rajaa held ultimate power; in Vajji the assembly took major decisions and chose the ruler

(B) Magadha practised farming while Vajji did not

(C) Magadha had no army while Vajji had a large one

(D) Vajji used iron while Magadha used only bronze

**40.** Counterfactual: if iron metallurgy had NEVER spread in ancient India, the MOST likely outcome, by the chapter's reasoning, would be that:

(A) Clearing forests and ploughing heavy soil would have been far harder, so the Second Urbanisation would have been much weaker

(B) Cities would have grown even faster than they did

(C) The Harappan civilisation would never have ended

(D) Coins would have been invented far sooner

**41.** A student says the gap between the two urbanisations proves 'cities once lost can never return.' The chapter's evidence BEST refutes this because:

(A) Cities did return — a wholly new urban wave rose in the Ganga plains after the long non-urban gap

(B) The Harappan cities were never actually abandoned

(C) There was in fact no gap between the two waves

(D) Cities have existed continuously since the Stone Age

**42.** Why is it a mistake to treat janapada and mahaajanapada as simply two words for the same thing?

(A) A janapada was a coin and a mahaajanapada was a route

(B) A janapada came after the mahaajanapada in time

(C) A janapada was a smaller clan territory, while a mahaajanapada was a larger state formed by such units merging and growing

(D) A mahaajanapada was always a republic and a janapada always a monarchy

**43.** The presence of fortifications, taxation and standing armies in the mahaajanapadas is taken as a sign that they were:

(A) Loose bands of wanderers with no fixed authority

(B) Organised states with rulers who could command resources and defence

(C) Purely religious settlements with no government

(D) Identical reconstructions of Harappan cities



**44.** Taxation became a regular feature of the mahaajanapadas. The MOST important reason a state needed to collect taxes was to:

- (A) Replace farming so that no one needed to grow food
- (B) Discourage trade between neighbouring regions
- (C) Abolish the need for any kind of ruler
- (D) Pay for armies, fortifications and administration that the ruler maintained

**45.** A farmer in a Ganga-plains janapada switches from a wooden digging stick to an iron-tipped plough. The chain of consequences the chapter would predict is:

- (A) Harvests fall, so people abandon the land and cities shrink
- (B) Heavier soil can be worked, harvests rise, surplus feeds non-farmers, and towns can grow
- (C) Trade routes close because food no longer needs moving
- (D) The need for any ruler or taxes disappears

**46.** In which respect were the gana/sangha assemblies genuinely BROADER than a monarchy, even if narrower than a modern democracy?

- (A) Every adult, including all the poor, voted equally
- (B) Major decisions were shared among many family and clan heads rather than resting in one hereditary king
- (C) Only the single richest man decided everything
- (D) Decisions were made entirely by foreign rulers

**47.** Why does the appearance of punch-marked coins tell historians that TRADE had grown, not merely that metal was available?

- (A) Coins are a convenient medium of exchange, so their spread signals that buying and selling had outgrown simple barter
- (B) Coins were used only as jewellery, showing wealth alone
- (C) Coins were minted only to be buried with the dead
- (D) Coins prove that barter had become more popular than ever

**48.** Shishupalgarh, an eastern city with a neat square plan and strong fortifications, was the capital of which region?

- |              |             |
|--------------|-------------|
| (A) Gandhara | (B) Kalinga |
| (C) Avanti   | (D) Magadha |

**49.** A historian notes that mahaajanapada capitals shared three things: ramparts, moats and narrow gateways. Taken together, these features BEST reveal that the rulers were concerned with:

- (A) Defending their cities and controlling who entered, which states with rivals and wealth needed
- (B) Making the cities beautiful for festivals only
- (C) Storing rainwater for the dry season
- (D) Encouraging anyone to wander freely in and out

- 50.** The chapter treats the sixteen mahaajanapadas as spanning much of the Subcontinent. The BEST way to express what 'sixteen mahaajanapadas' represents is:
- (A) Sixteen successive empires, each replacing the last
  - (B) Sixteen tiny villages clustered in one valley
  - (C) A set of large, roughly contemporary states that between them covered a wide stretch of the land
  - (D) Sixteen names for the same single kingdom
- 51.** A coin from Avanti is found at a site in Gandhara, and an Anga coin turns up near the Godavari. The single explanation that fits BOTH finds is that:
- (A) Each coin was made on the spot where it was later found
  - (B) Coins circulated along the trade routes, so a region's coins could end up far from where they were made
  - (C) All four regions shared one identical official coin
  - (D) Coins were forbidden to leave their region of origin
- 52.** Why does the chapter present the rise of cities, states and coins as ONE connected story rather than three unrelated events?
- (A) They happened in three different millennia with no link
  - (B) Coins appeared first and only later caused any farming
  - (C) Each happened in a separate continent
  - (D) Surplus farming fed cities and states, growing trade required coins, and all reinforced one another
- 53.** Within a monarchical mahaajanapada, what was the relationship between the rajaa and the sabha/samiti?
- (A) The assemblies ruled directly and the king was only a figurehead
  - (B) The king ignored the assemblies, which had no role at all
  - (C) The assemblies chose a new king every year by vote
  - (D) The king ruled but was expected to consult these assemblies and his ministers rather than act alone
- 54.** The names sabha and samiti are first found in the Vedas, while terms like gana and sangha describe later political forms. What does this layering of vocabulary suggest to a historian?
- (A) The Vedas were written after the mahaajanapadas had ended
  - (B) Assemblies were a brand-new invention with no earlier roots
  - (C) Ideas of collective counsel were old and evolved over time into the assemblies and republics of the mahaajanapada age
  - (D) Gana and sangha mean exactly the same as a hereditary king
- 55.** If a region had fertile soil and iron but lay completely off all trade routes, the chapter's reasoning suggests its prospects as a great state would be:

- (A) Weaker, because without trade links it would miss the exchange of goods, coins and ideas that helped states flourish
- (B) Stronger, because isolation always protects a state
- (C) Unchanged, because trade played no role in state growth
- (D) Guaranteed to become the largest empire

**56.** A museum labels a silver punch-marked coin: 'First Urbanisation, Harappan period.' Why is this label historically wrong?

- (A) Punch-marked coins belong to the Second Urbanisation; the Harappans of the First Urbanisation did not use coined money
- (B) Because the Harappans used only gold coins, never silver
- (C) Because coins were never used anywhere in ancient India
- (D) Because punch-marked coins were made of iron, not silver

**57.** Putting the chapter together, which statement BEST captures why the Ganga plains, and not the old Indus region, became the heartland of the Second Urbanisation?

- (A) The Harappans simply rebuilt their old Indus cities exactly as before
- (B) The Ganga plains had no farming, so people gathered there for safety
- (C) The new mix of fertile soil, iron, surplus farming and connecting routes came together in the Ganga plains, where the second wave of cities and states then arose
- (D) Iron was unknown in the Ganga plains, forcing reliance on bronze

**58.** A historian says iron tools were necessary for the Second Urbanisation but NOT by themselves sufficient. Which observation BEST illustrates the 'not sufficient' part?

- (A) Iron alone, with nothing else, instantly produced great cities everywhere
- (B) Iron was never actually used in the Ganga plains at all
- (C) Cities appeared long before iron and so did not need it
- (D) Iron also had to combine with fertile soil, trade routes and organised rulers before cities and states could actually grow

**59.** Why might a historian be cautious about taking the famous list of 'sixteen mahaajanapadas' as a perfectly exact, fixed count?

- (A) Because the real number was certainly exactly one hundred
- (B) It is the most-cited list, but such ancient lists reflect how texts grouped the states rather than a single official census
- (C) Because mahaajanapadas never existed and the list is invented
- (D) Because the list was compiled by the Harappans before they vanished

**60.** A teacher draws a timeline marker: 'janapadas merge into mahaajanapadas.' Reasoning about WHY this merging happened, the BEST explanation is:

- (A) Stronger janapadas absorbed weaker neighbours through war and alliance, helped by iron weapons and growing wealth, forming larger states
- (B) The Harappans returned and combined the janapadas for them

- (C) All janapadas peacefully dissolved because no one wanted land any more
- (D) Foreign empires arrived first and split big states into janapadas

# Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 4: New Beginnings: Cities and States — Paper 3

## Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

## Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans |
|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|
| 1  | A   | 11 | C   | 21 | D   | 31 | C   | 41 | A   | 51 | B   |
| 2  | C   | 12 | D   | 22 | A   | 32 | D   | 42 | C   | 52 | D   |
| 3  | B   | 13 | D   | 23 | B   | 33 | C   | 43 | B   | 53 | D   |
| 4  | C   | 14 | C   | 24 | C   | 34 | B   | 44 | D   | 54 | C   |
| 5  | C   | 15 | C   | 25 | A   | 35 | B   | 45 | B   | 55 | A   |
| 6  | B   | 16 | D   | 26 | B   | 36 | A   | 46 | B   | 56 | A   |
| 7  | C   | 17 | D   | 27 | A   | 37 | B   | 47 | A   | 57 | C   |
| 8  | A   | 18 | A   | 28 | C   | 38 | D   | 48 | B   | 58 | D   |
| 9  | B   | 19 | B   | 29 | D   | 39 | A   | 49 | A   | 59 | B   |
| 10 | D   | 20 | D   | 30 | D   | 40 | A   | 50 | C   | 60 | A   |

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

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## Worked Solutions

**1. (A)** The Harappans were skilled in copper and bronze but did not work iron; iron tools became common only in the later, Ganga-plains phase. So an iron plough is an anachronism for the First Urbanisation. Planned drainage, a script and standardised weights are all genuine, well-attested features of Harappan cities, so none of those is the odd one out.

**2. (C)** After the Harappan urban order collapsed, urban life was largely absent for about a thousand years and people returned to village life, losing large-scale trade, writing and administration. It was not a continuous city life, nor a brief hundred-year gap, nor a flourishing of iron cities — those cities of the second wave appeared only at the END of this long non-urban stretch.

**3. (B)** The second wave grew up in the Ganga plains, about a thousand years after the Harappan collapse, with its own new elements — iron tools, punch-marked coins, fresh capitals. Calling it a 'revival' would wrongly imply the same people resumed the same

Indus cities; in fact it was a separate, later development in a new region, so 'Second Urbanisation' fits better.

**4. (C)** An 'urban order' is the whole working system — trade, writing, administration — not just the physical structures. The strongest evidence is that all of these faded and people reverted to villages. The claim is not supported by saying life simply continued, or that bigger cities or iron appeared at once; those would actually contradict a loss of urban order.

**5. (C)** When independent lines of evidence — physical remains and ancient books — point the same way, the reconstruction is much more trustworthy. Neither source replaces the other: texts cannot substitute for digging, and excavated objects do not record spoken words. And the texts of this period were not written by the much earlier Harappans, whose script remains undeciphered.

**6. (B)** The Harappan civilisation came first; long after its collapse, settled clans formed janapadas; these merged into the larger mahaajanapadas; and the mahaajanapadas in turn gave way to the first empires. Janapadas must precede the mahaajanapadas (the larger states grew out of them), and empires come after the mahaajanapadas, not before — which rules out the other orders.

**7. (C)** 'Where the people set foot' points to a place a community settled and identified with — a clan's home territory. The image of a foot does NOT mean a moving army (the whole point is that they stopped moving and settled), nor a coin, nor a sprawling empire, which is far larger than a single clan's land.

**8. (A)** A state needs settled people, a defined territory and an organising authority — and janapadas had all three: clans tied to land and led by a rajaa. They did have a leader, so it is wrong to say they had none; they were not Harappan creations; and coins (silver, not iron) belong to a later stage, not the origin of janapadas.

**9. (B)** The bigger states formed by amalgamation were the mahaajanapadas ('great janapadas'), and the best-known list names sixteen. 'Ganas' and 'sanghas' are not the general term for these states — they describe a particular non-monarchical TYPE among them — and 'janapada' is the smaller earlier unit, not the larger merged one.

**10. (D)** Rich alluvial soil, access to iron, and river-and-route connectivity together let surplus food feed cities and armies — exactly what states need. The plains were neither cold-and-dry nor riverless (rivers were a key advantage), and the Harappan heartland lay in the northwest, not the Ganga plains, so it was not Harappan capitals that seeded these states.

**11. (C)** A moat is a deep, wide, water-filled ditch placed before the walls so enemies cannot easily approach — a defensive feature, paired with the ramparts. It was not built as a

reservoir for festivals, nor a garden boundary, nor a marketplace; those would not explain why it sits OUTSIDE the fortification ring.

**12. (D)** A narrow gate funnels traffic, so a small guard force can watch and regulate movement — useful for security and for collecting tolls or taxes. It is not about drainage, appearance, or letting large animals pass abreast (a wide gate would do that); the controlling-access reason is the one tied to how a fortified state manages its capital.

**13. (D)** If a site is occupied continuously for 2,500 years, the safest conclusion is that its location had enduring advantages — fertile surroundings, river access, trade position. Continuity does NOT mean these cities are frozen and unchanged, nor that the much earlier Harappans founded them, nor that they lacked walls (in fact they were fortified mahaajanapada capitals).

**14. (C)** The existence of advisory assemblies shows that a good rajaa governed WITH counsel rather than purely by his own will. It does not mean the king was powerless (he still ruled), nor that he was annually elected (kingship was hereditary in monarchies), nor that kings were absent — the assemblies advised the king, they did not abolish him.

**15. (C)** 'Hereditary' means power is inherited by birth, so the crown usually went to the king's son or kin. That is exactly what distinguishes a monarchy from a gana/sangha, where the ASSEMBLY chose the ruler. It was not decided by an annual vote, nor handed to the richest trader, nor automatically to a foreign conqueror.

**16. (D)** In a gana/sangha, major decisions — including who would be rajaa — lay with the assembly, settled by debate and a vote if necessary. That is the very feature that makes it a republic rather than a monarchy, where succession was by birth (eldest son). Priestly or foreign-imposed selection is not how these early republics chose their leaders.

**17. (D)** What makes a state a 'republic' is that authority rests with an assembly that decides and chooses the ruler, rather than a king inheriting the throne. Size, army strength and the use of coins were shared with many monarchies and do not define a republic; the decision-making power of the assembly is the defining trait of Vajji and Malla.

**18. (A)** The accurate picture is a majority of monarchies plus at least two republics (Vajji and Malla). So the blanket claim is wrong because of those exceptions — but it is also wrong to swing to the opposite extreme and say none had kings, since most DID. The mahaajanapadas were not defined by being southern, so that qualifier is irrelevant.

**19. (B)** These republics gave decision-making to assemblies of clan and family heads — broad for their time, but not the one-person-one-vote inclusion of a modern democracy. They certainly HAD assemblies (that is their hallmark), their rulers were NOT chosen purely by birth (that would make them monarchies), and decision-making was not restricted to women — so 'early' rather than 'modern' is the right qualification.

**20. (D)** The Harappans worked copper and bronze; iron became widespread only later and powered the Ganga-plains cities. So the claim that the Harappans used iron is reversed and wrong. Neither wave relied on gold tools, and coins (when they came) were silver punch-marked pieces, not iron — making the copper/bronze-versus-iron contrast the correct one.

**21. (D)** Iron's importance is practical and agricultural: tougher axes and ploughshares opened forested, heavy land, increasing harvests that could support non-farming city dwellers and soldiers — the foundation of states. Iron was a working metal, not an object of worship; it did not abolish trade (which in fact grew); and books were not printed in this period.

**22. (A)** Better iron weapons made armies more effective, which helped powerful states defeat and absorb rivals, producing larger kingdoms — a step toward empires. It did not end warfare (it intensified it), did not end farming (which actually expanded with iron ploughs), and writing's appearance is a separate matter, not a result of iron weapons.

**23. (B)** They are called 'punch-marked' because marks were punched onto the metal; they were silver, not shells or poured gold. The name has nothing to do with boxing prizes. Cowrie shells were a different, earlier medium of exchange, and casting is not the method these particular coins were made by.

**24. (C)** Barter's awkwardness is the 'double coincidence of wants' — both sides must want what the other offers — which coins neatly avoid by acting as a common measure of value. Barter was not limited to night-time, did not depend on banks, and did not require iron tools; coins simply made exchange easier than swapping goods directly.

**25. (A)** Coins turning up far from their origin is the natural signature of long-distance trade carrying them along the routes; regions used neighbours' coins and some even reached abroad. It is not evidence of forgery, nor of a single shared coin (each region usually made its own), nor of coins being confined to one city — that would contradict the very find being explained.

**26. (B)** A jaati was a community defined by occupation, with skills and customs handed down within families. It is not a defensive feature (that is a moat), not a travel route (that is a patha), and not a coin. The varna-jaati framework was about social and occupational organisation, not fortification, transport or money.

**27. (A)** Kshatriyas were the varna associated with protection and warfare. Brahmins were linked to knowledge and rituals (not battle), Vaishyas with trade and agriculture (not rituals), and Shudras with service occupations (not ruling as warriors). Only the Kshatriya-warrior pairing matches the roles described.

**28. (C)** The chapter stresses that in this early phase the system was more flexible, with movement between occupations possible. It did exist (so denying it is wrong), it belongs to



the Ganga-plains age and not the much earlier Harappans, and it was not instantly rigid — that very rigidity came later, which is exactly the misconception being corrected.

**29. (D)** 'Uttara' means north and 'dakshina' means south, so the Uttaraapatha was the northern route and the Dakshinaapatha headed south — the names themselves give the directions away. They were not reversed, were not confined to a coastal east-west line, and spanned many regions rather than lying inside one mahaajanapada.

**30. (D)** To go from the northern plains into the peninsula, the southern route crossed the Vindhyas, the dividing range between north and south India. The Himalayas lie far to the north (the wrong direction), the Aravallis run through the northwest, and the Western Ghats edge the western coast — none of these is the range a route from Kaushambi southward would cross.

**31. (C)** The routes were arteries for people and ideas as well as merchandise — pilgrims, armies, beliefs and coins all travelled along them, spreading culture. They were not limited to royal letters, not only to soldiers, and not merely to iron ore; it was precisely this mix of people, goods and ideas that helped unify the regions.

**32. (D)** The southern trio were the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas. Magadha, Kosala and Avanti were powerful NORTHERN mahaajanapadas; Vajji, Malla and Anga also lay in the north/east; and Kuru, Panchaala and Matsya were northern janapadas/mahaajanapadas too — only the Chola-Chera-Pandya set is southern.

**33. (C)** The south's prized resources — gems, gold, spices — pulled it into the trade networks of the wider land. A cold climate is neither accurate nor a draw for trade, the absence of rivers would hinder not help, and the south's coastal position (closeness to the sea) actually aided maritime trade rather than cutting it off.

**34. (B)** By this date trade, coins and ideas had linked the regions into a single connected land, with influence spilling beyond India's borders. It was not depopulated, not physically fragmented into islands, and certainly not restored to Harappan rule — the Harappan civilisation had ended a thousand years earlier.

**35. (B)** As the land integrated, the mahaajanapadas gave way to the early empires — the next, larger stage of state formation. They were not newly founded then (that was centuries earlier), did not all turn into republics, and did not migrate to the Indus valley; their era was ending, not beginning.

**36. (A)** The driving sequence runs from iron, to cleared land, to surplus food, to cities and states — each step enabling the next. Coins came AFTER barter and helped trade grow rather than stop it; cities growing did not regrow forests or erase iron; and empires came LAST, after janapadas and settled clans, not before them.

**37. (B)** Magadha's strength flowed from its fertile Ganga location: rich harvests, river routes for movement and trade, and access to resources like iron — the very ingredients the chapter ties to powerful states. It was not riverless (rivers were an asset, not a defensive gap), was a monarchy rather than a republic, and lay in the north, not the southern Pandya country.

**38. (D)** The clearest support is that cities founded in this second wave, like Varanasi, are still alive and busy after roughly 2,500 years — an unbroken thread. The Harappan (First-Urbanisation) cities are NOT still inhabited, iron remains in use, and barter is no longer the main form of trade — so none of those supports the claim.

**39. (A)** The essential contrast is WHO decides: a single inheriting king in the monarchy versus a decision-making assembly that also picks the ruler in the republic. Both relied on farming, both maintained armies, and both belonged to the iron age — so the farming, army and metal claims fail to capture the real difference, which is the locus of political power.

**40. (A)** Since iron tools enabled the land-clearing and farming that produced the surplus behind the cities, removing iron would have starved that surplus and weakened the urban wave. Without iron, cities would grow SLOWER, not faster; the Harappan collapse had already happened long before and is unrelated; and there is no reason coins would appear sooner — the whole money economy rested on the trade that iron-fed growth made possible.

**41. (A)** The Second Urbanisation itself disproves the claim: after roughly a thousand years without cities, urban life reappeared in a new region. The refutation is NOT that the Harappan cities survived (they were indeed lost), nor that there was no gap (the gap is well attested), nor a sweeping claim of cities since the Stone Age — the point is precisely that cities can be lost AND can later re-emerge.

**42. (C)** The prefix 'maha-' (great) marks the difference in scale: mahaajanapadas were the bigger states into which the earlier, smaller janapadas merged. Neither word names a coin or a route, the janapada came BEFORE (not after) the mahaajanapada, and being a republic or monarchy is not what separates the two terms — size and stage of development are.

**43. (B)** Walls, tax collection and armies require an authority able to gather and direct resources — the hallmarks of organised states. They are not the marks of rootless wanderers or of stateless religious camps, and they were new developments of the Ganga age, not copies of the earlier Harappan cities, whose order had long since collapsed.

**44. (D)** Taxes funded the costly business of running a state — soldiers, walls, officials. They did not replace farming (taxes were often levied ON farm produce), did not aim to

choke trade (states benefited from trade), and certainly did not abolish rulers — collecting revenue is one of the very things a ruler did.

**45. (B)** An iron plough lets a farmer break tougher soil and grow more, generating the surplus that supports town-dwellers — the engine of urban growth. Harvests rise rather than fall, more surplus means MORE trade not less, and a larger, settled, taxed population needs rulers and administration more than ever — so the other chains run backwards.

**46. (B)** The republics spread decision-making across the heads of leading families — broader than one king's will, yet not the universal participation of a modern democracy. They did not give every adult an equal vote, did not concentrate everything in one rich individual, and were not run by foreigners — they sat between absolute monarchy and full democracy.

**47. (A)** Coins exist to make exchange easier, so their widespread use is direct evidence that commerce had expanded beyond what barter could handle. They were not primarily ornaments, not made merely as grave goods, and their rise marks a move AWAY from barter, not toward it — so only the trade-growth reading fits.

**48. (B)** Shishupalgarh, in the east with its square fortified plan, was the capital associated with Kalinga. Gandhara lay in the far northwest, Avanti in central-western India, and Magadha (in Bihar) had its own capitals such as Rajagriha — none of those matches an eastern, square-planned site.

**49. (A)** Walls, water-ditches and pinch-point gates are a coherent defensive-and-control package, exactly what a wealthy state with neighbouring rivals would build. Beauty, water storage and free movement are each contradicted by at least one feature — narrow gates restrict movement, and the whole set is about security, not decoration or rainwater.

**50. (C)** The sixteen were large states existing around the same era and spread across a broad region, from the northwest to the east. They were not a sequence of empires one after another, not a knot of villages in one valley, and not aliases for one kingdom — they were many distinct, sizeable, contemporaneous states.

**51. (B)** Coins travelling far from home is the natural result of long-distance trade moving them along the routes, and one explanation covers both scattered finds. It is not that each coin was minted where found, not that all regions used a single shared coin (each usually struck its own), and not that coins were confined to their region — that would make the finds impossible.

**52. (D)** The developments are interlinked: agricultural surplus underpinned cities and states, the resulting trade called for coins, and each fed back into the others — a single web of cause and effect. They were roughly contemporary (not spread across separate millennia), surplus farming preceded and enabled coins (not the reverse), and all unfolded in the same land.

**53. (D)** In a monarchy the rajaa held power yet was supposed to take counsel from the sabhaa and samiti and from ministers — shared advice, not shared rule. The assemblies did not govern in his place (that would be a republic), they were not powerless ornaments, and they did not annually elect the king, whose office was hereditary.

**54. (C)** Older Vedic words for assemblies alongside later republican terms imply a continuous, developing tradition of collective decision-making. It does not mean the Vedas postdate the mahaajanapadas, nor that assemblies sprang up from nowhere (the Vedic terms show earlier roots), and gana/sangha denote republics, the opposite of a hereditary kingship.

**55. (A)** Fertile soil and iron give surplus, but the chapter ties powerful states to connectivity too — trade carried goods, coins and ideas that strengthened them. Cut off from routes, such a region would lose that advantage and likely stay weaker. Isolation is not portrayed as protective, trade did matter, and nothing guarantees empire from soil and iron alone.

**56. (A)** Coins appeared in the LATER, Ganga-plains wave; the Harappans had no coinage at all, so dating a coin to the Harappan period is the error. The Harappans did not use gold coins either, coins certainly were used in ancient India (just later), and punch-marked coins were silver, not iron — so only the urbanisation-dating correction is right.

**57. (C)** The Second Urbanisation took root where its enabling conditions converged — the fertile, iron-rich, route-linked Ganga plains — rather than reviving the distant, long-collapsed Indus cities. The Ganga plains were intensely farmed (not farmless), and iron was central there (not absent), so the rebuild-the-Indus and no-iron explanations both fail; the convergence of new conditions in a new region is the key.

**58. (D)** 'Necessary but not sufficient' means iron was required yet not enough on its own — it had to act together with rich soil, trade links and ruling authority to yield cities and states. Saying iron alone instantly built cities is the opposite (claiming sufficiency); saying iron was absent denies its necessity; and saying cities preceded iron contradicts the chapter's sequence in which iron came first and enabled the growth.

**59. (B)** The sixteen is the best-known traditional list, but ancient texts grouped states in their own ways, so it is a useful convention rather than a precise modern headcount — hence a little caution. The number was not certainly a hundred, the mahaajanapadas were real states, and the list comes from the later textual tradition, not from the much earlier Harappans.

**60. (A)** Larger states formed as more powerful janapadas, backed by iron arms and surplus wealth, defeated or absorbed weaker ones into bigger mahaajanapadas. The Harappans had long since vanished and played no part; the janapadas did not dissolve

from loss of interest in land (clans were strongly tied to their territory); and the direction of change was small-to-large, not empires splitting states into janapadas.